Enrique Escalante

Associate Professor of Economics

Norris-Vincent College of Business, Angelo State University
Research Assistant Professor, Free Market Institute, Texas Tech University

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Research Interests

Political economy of violence and development; development economics; political conflict and regimes; applied econometrics; price theory.

Academic Positions

Angelo State University, Norris-Vincent College of Business

Associate Professor of Economics	2026–present
Assistant Professor of Economics	2021–2026
Instructor of Economics	2019–2021

Texas Tech University, Free Market Institute

Research Assistant Professor	2021–present
Research Associate	2019–2021

Education

Ph.D., Agricultural and Applied Economics, Texas Tech University	2019
M.S., Agricultural and Applied Economics, Texas Tech University	2017
B.S., Electrical Engineering, San Antonio Abad University, Cusco, Peru	2007

Journal Articles (Published and Forthcoming)

"The Odd Couple: Formal and Informal Governance in the Making of Fiscal Capacity." *Journal of Comparative Economics* (forthcoming).

"Friends or Foes? The Insurgent's Dilemma of Seeking Legitimacy While Keeping Secrets." *World Development*, 199 (2026).

"A Self-Defense Network against Terrorism and Crime: Evidence from Peru." *Terrorism and Political Violence*, 35(4), 828–845 (2023).

"The Influence of Pinochet on the Chilean Miracle." *Latin American Research Review*, 57(4), 831–847 (2022).

"Night Watchers and Terrorists." *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, 171, 116–131 (2020).

(with Raymond March) "Fighting on Christmas: Brawling as Self-Governance in Rural Peru." *Journal of Institutional Economics*, 16(3), 355–368 (2020).

Book Chapters

"Por la Razón o la Fuerza: What Caused Chile's Economic Miracle?" In *The Pinochet Shock: Radical Change and Life Under Dictatorship*. London: Palgrave Macmillan, 2025.

(with Peter C. Earle) "Operation Warp Speed." In *Pandemics and Liberty*. North Haven, CT: American Institute for Economic Research, 2022.

Working Papers (Under Review)

"Resource Shocks and Local Enforcement Activity: Evidence from Peru." Under review, *World Bank Economic Review*.

Policy Engagement & Media

"Most U.S. Cities Have Terrorism Insurance, Including Lubbock," *Everything Lubbock*, 2026.

"En Clave Económica," *Gestión Mundo*, 2026. (Spanish)

"En Radar 24," *Gestión Mundo*, 2026. (Spanish)

"America's K-Shaped Economy," *The Talk Diaries with Tanya Beckett*, 2026.

"The State of the U.S. Economy," *The Talk Diaries with Tanya Beckett*, 2025.

"Misjudging Peruvian Vargas Llosa," *Wall Street Journal* (Letter to the Editor), 2025.

"Valor Agregado," *Canal B*, 2025. (Spanish)

"Upsides and Risks of Increasing State Capacity," *Cato Daily Podcast*, 2024.

"Why Did Peru Have Such a Bad Pandemic?" *The Inquiry*, BBC, 2020.

Academic Seminars and Conferences

2026 (scheduled): Public Choice Society, APEE, Southern Economic Association, Mont Pelerin Society.

2025: Public Choice Society, APEE, Southern Economic Association.

2024: Center for Governance and Markets (Univ. of Pittsburgh), Public Choice Society, APEE, Warsaw Economic Seminars (Univ. of Warsaw), Peruvian Economic Association, Southern Economic Association, WINIR.

2023: Southern Economic Association, Public Choice Society, APEE, Universidad Andina del Cusco, UNSAAC (Cusco, Peru).

2022: Southern Economic Association, Public Choice Society, APEE.

2021: Southern Economic Association, Liberty Fund Latin America (TTU), Public Choice Society, APEE.

2020: Southern Economic Association.

2019: Voluntary Governance (Arizona State University), Public Choice Society, APEE.

Teaching Experience

Angelo State University. Intermediate Microeconomics; Quantitative Methods for Social Sciences; Development Economics; International Economics; Principles of Microeconomics; Principles of Macroeconomics.

- Developed and taught upper-level courses emphasizing causal inference and applied research design.
- Supervised undergraduate research presented at external conferences and competitions.
- Mentored students in empirical analysis, data collection, and research presentation.

- *Political Economy Reading Group* (2021–2026): designed and led an interdisciplinary seminar with scholarships tied to sustained engagement.

Texas Tech University. Applied Business Economics (2017–2018).
Universidad Francisco Marroquín (Guatemala). Advanced Seminar on Economics (2017).

Awards

President's Award for Faculty Excellence, Angelo State University (finalist nominee), 2021.

Hayek Fund, Institute for Humane Studies, 2018.

Young Scholar Award, Association of Private Enterprise Education, 2016–2017.

Atlas Network Award for Student Outreach (Francisco Marroquín), 2013 — "For exceptional work with student groups in remote regions of Peru" (as Director, Andes Libres Institute).

Professional Activities

Referee service: Journal of Comparative Economics; Economics Letters; Southern Economic Journal; Public Choice; Journal of Public Finance and Public Choice; Latin American Research Review; Journal of Institutional Economics; Journal of Private Enterprise.

Non-academic: Executive Director and Founder, Andes Libres Public Policy Institute, Peru (2008–2015).

Skills

Languages: English (fluent), Spanish (native), French (basic), Quechua (basic).
Software: R, Python.